

DOCUMENTATION ESSENTIAL · PROPERTY CLAIMS

Don't Throw It Away.

Every item you discard before documentation is money your claim can't recover.

C — Capture**L** — Log**A** — Analyze**I** — Inquire**M** — Manage

Your damaged belongings are evidence. Treat them that way.

STRUCTURE**Damaged Building Materials**

Your adjuster must document the full scope of loss before any materials are cleared away.

TIP Bag and label samples if items are too large to keep intact.

EQUIPMENT**Appliances & Electronics**

Serial numbers are required to verify replacement cost value with your insurer.

TIP Photograph the data plate even if the unit is completely destroyed.

MOISTURE DAMAGE**Wet or Moldy Items**

Disposal before documentation creates a disputed claim. Proof of damage is everything.

TIP Photograph before any drying, cleaning, or remediation begins.

CONTENTS**Furniture & Fixtures**

Replacement cost relies on documented condition, not on memory or verbal estimates.

TIP Video-pan each room before moving a single piece of furniture.

PERSONAL PROPERTY**Clothing & Personal Items**

Contents are the most underestimated loss category in home insurance claims.

TIP Photograph by room in piles; then itemize with brand and approximate value.

RECORDS**Receipts, Tags & Manuals**

Original purchase documentation is your strongest proof of replacement cost value.

TIP Scan or photograph every tag and manual before anything is discarded.

DOCUMENT FIRST. CLEAN UP SECOND.

You can always clean after documentation. You cannot recreate evidence once it is gone.

INSURANCE REALITY

Insurers are not required to pay for damage they cannot verify. The burden of proof belongs to you. Thorough documentation is how you meet that burden and protect the full value of your settlement.